

PARLIAMENTARY SYSTEM

RESPONSIBLE GOVERNMENT → NOMINAL AND REAL EXECUTIVE → COLLECTIVE RESPONSIBILITY → CONFIDENCE AND DISSOLUTION → CABINET AND PM → ACCOUNTABILITY → PRESIDENTIAL COMPARISON → INDIAN ADAPTATION → ANSWER SYNTHESIS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. The grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW Approval: FALSE Pending user review active generation g2 repaired in place for answer-line and visual-boundary quality all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA prior artefacts unchanged exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 RESPONSIBLE GOVERNMENT: THE CONSTITUTIONAL MAP

RESPONSIBLE GOVERNMENT ARTICLES 74-75 ARTICLES 77-78 ARTICLES 163-164 NOMINAL EXECUTIVE REAL EXECUTIVE LOK SABHA CONFIDENCE

UNION ARCHITECTURE

- Articles 74-75: PM-led Council and collective responsibility.
- Article 77: conduct of Union business.
- Article 78: PM-President information duties.

STATE PARALLELS

- Articles 163-164: CM-led Council and Assembly responsibility.
- Articles 166-167: State business and information duties.
- The architecture is parallel with bounded contextual differences.

SYSTEM LOGIC

- Election creates the House.
- House majority supports the ministry.
- Continuing confidence sustains authority.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: “Cabinet government” may name the constitutional form, while “cabinet dominance” or “prime-ministerial government” are later analytical claims about the internal distribution of power.

01

STAGE 01 NOMINAL HEAD, REAL EXECUTIVE AND BINDING ADVICE

PRESIDENT PRIME MINISTER COUNCIL OF MINISTERS ARTICLE 74 RECONSIDERATION ONCE ARTICLE 74(2) LIMITED DISCRETION

Formal authority

Ministerial advice

One reconsideration

Binding reconsidered advice

FORMAL AND REAL POWER

- The President is constitutional head.
- The PM and Council form the real political executive.
- Policy authority carries Lok Sabha responsibility.

ADVICE RULE

- Article 74 advice normally binds.
- The President may once require reconsideration.
- Reconsidered advice binds.

BOUNDARIES

- Article 74(2) protects inquiry into advice.
- Underlying legality may still be reviewed.
- Hung-House appointment and dissolution use convention and floor testing.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Courts may review the action on constitutional grounds while Article 74(2) protects the advice itself from inquiry.

02

STAGE 02 CLASSIC FEATURES AND COLLECTIVE RESPONSIBILITY

DUAL EXECUTIVE MAJORITY OR COALITION COLLECTIVE RESPONSIBILITY DOUBLE MEMBERSHIP PM LEADERSHIP DISSOLUTION CABINET SOLIDARITY

SYSTEM FEATURES

- Dual executive and majority or coalition rule.
- Executive drawn from legislature.
- PM leadership and possible lower-House dissolution.

COLLECTIVE RULE

- Cabinet decisions bind all ministers publicly.
- A dissenting minister must accept or resign.
- Loss of Lok Sabha confidence affects the entire ministry.

INDIVIDUAL RULE / LIMIT

- A minister may leave for misconduct or failure.
- Individual departure need not topple government.
- Fusion does not erase courts, bicameralism or elections.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The President is normally a nominal executive, but bounded discretion and information rights prevent the office from becoming constitutionally irrelevant.

03

STAGE 03 CONFIDENCE, DISSOLUTION AND CARETAKER CONVENTIONS

MAJORITY GOVERNMENT COALITION MINORITY GOVERNMENT NO-CONFIDENCE FLOOR TEST RESIGNATION DISSOLUTION CARETAKER

Government formation

Continuing confidence

Floor test

Resignation or dissolution

Caretaker transition

GOVERNMENT FORMS

- Majority ministry.
- Coalition ministry.
- Minority ministry with outside support.

CONFIDENCE TEST

- No-confidence or confidence motion.
- Floor test where majority is disputed.
- Defeat on an expressly treated confidence issue.

LOSS AND TRANSITION

- Resign or seek lawful dissolution.
- Constitutional head may assess a viable alternative.
- Caretaker government preserves continuity with restraint.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: In the Article 356 context, legislative majority should ordinarily be tested on the Assembly floor rather than inferred from subjective claims outside the House; proclamation material is judicially reviewable.

04

STAGE 04 CABINET, COUNCIL AND PRIME MINISTERIAL LEADERSHIP

COUNCIL OF MINISTERS CABINET CABINET COMMITTEES PRIME MINISTER PORTFOLIOS ARTICLE 78 CABINET SECRETARIAT

COUNCIL

- The wider constitutional ministry includes several ranks.
- All share collective responsibility.
- The Council is not identical to the Cabinet.

CABINET

- Smaller inner decision core.
- Handles policy, legislation, budget and crisis choices.
- Cabinet Committees specialise coordination.

PRIME MINISTER

- Selects and allocates portfolios through advice.
- Chairs Cabinet and leads the majority or coalition.
- Connects President, ministry and Parliament under Article 78.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The Cabinet Secretariat page accessed on 24 August 2026 confirms business-rule administration, Cabinet assistance and inter-ministerial coordination.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 123 permits temporary legislation when Parliament is not in session, but repeated or strategic ordinances can bypass deliberation and weaken legislative accountability.

05

STAGE 05 PARLIAMENTARY ACCOUNTABILITY AND EXECUTIVE DOMINANCE

QUESTION HOUR MOTIONS BUDGET COMMITTEES CAG-PAC OPPOSITION JUDICIAL REVIEW ANTI-DEFECTION

LEGISLATIVE SCRUTINY

- Questions, debates, motions and confidence devices.
- Budget, grants and financial committees.
- Bill and delegated-legislation committees.

WIDER CORRECTIVES

- CAG-PAC chain and constitutional offices.
- Opposition, media, Rajya Sabha and elections.
- Judicial review and transparency law.

RISKS / REFORM

- Whip and anti-defection pressure limit dissent.
- Compressed sittings and information asymmetry weaken scrutiny.
- More time, information and committee capacity improve responsibility.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Declining deliberation calls for stronger sittings, committees and scrutiny practices, not abandonment of a parliamentary system whose accountability mechanisms remain constitutionally available.

06

STAGE 06 PARLIAMENTARY VERSUS PRESIDENTIAL GOVERNMENT

FUSION SEPARATION CONTINUING CONFIDENCE FIXED TERM DUAL EXECUTIVE SINGLE EXECUTIVE ACCOUNTABILITY STABILITY

Axis

Survival
Personnel
Gain
Risk

Parliamentary

House confidence
overlap
accountability
dominance/instability

Presidential

fixed term
separation
stability
deadlock

PARLIAMENTARY

- Fusion and interdependence.
- Ministry survives on House confidence.
- Continuous accountability and flexible replacement.

PRESIDENTIAL

- Organisational separation.
- President normally has a fixed term.
- Tenure stability, but possible deadlock.

INDIAN PRECISION

- India combines parliamentary responsibility with federalism and review.
- UK has orthodox parliamentary sovereignty.
- US has a separately elected executive.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Secretaries are accountable within the executive and subject to oversight, law and confirmation structures, but the President’s tenure does not depend on lower-House confidence.

07

STAGE 07 INDIAN ADAPTATION, COALITIONS AND CURRENT DEBATE

DIVERSITY COALITION MINORITY GOVERNMENT PM DOMINANCE ANTI-DEFECTION 129TH BILL ARTICLE 82A PROPOSAL STABILITY VS ACCOUNTABILITY

WHY ADOPTED

- Familiarity and continuity.
- Accommodation of diversity through legislature.
- Daily responsibility and flexible government change.

INDIAN EXPERIENCE

- Coalition bargaining can broaden inclusion.
- Minority governments intensify confidence politics.
- PM dominance and anti-defection can weaken deliberation.

CURRENT CONTROL

- The 129th Amendment Bill remains under committee review.
- Proposed Article 82A is not current text.
- Use simultaneous elections only for system analysis.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: India chose a responsible executive dependent on legislative confidence because continuous accountability and coordination were preferred to an independently fixed presidential tenure.

08

STAGE 08 FINAL SYNTHESIS: TRAPS, PYQS AND ANSWER SPINE

ARTICLES 74-75 COLLECTIVE RESPONSIBILITY CONFIDENCE CABINET VS COUNCIL ACCOUNTABILITY COMPARISON CURRENT CONTROL MAINS SPINE

PRELIMS CONTROL

- Union: 74-75; States: 163-164.
- Responsibility is to the popular House.
- A non-member minister has six consecutive months.

PYQ ROUTES

- 2020 and 2021 Prelims.
- 2018, 2023 and 2024 GS-II.
- Historical objective keys remain inferred where absent.

MAINS LADDER

- Define the executive-legislature relationship.
- Map advice, confidence and responsibility.
- Add accountability and comparison.
- Evaluate dominance, coalitions and reform.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Connect constitutional Articles to confidence mechanics, scrutiny institutions, comparison and a qualified stability-responsibility verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cabinet dominance: The cabinet and PM can marginalise legislative scrutiny through majority, whip and agenda control, but they do not acquire British-style legal sovereignty.

E

EXTRA OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT: CABINET GOVERNMENT THEORY

OPTIONAL ONLY BAGEHOT JENNINGS ELECTIVE DICTATORSHIP CORE EXECUTIVE PRESIDENTIALISATION

ENRICHMENT

- Bagehot explains Cabinet linkage; Jennings stresses convention.
- Elective-dictatorship and core-executive labels analyse dominance.

USE WITH DISCIPLINE

- Labels do not change Articles 74-75.
- Presidentialisation is analytical, not legal conversion.
- Add only after the complete core answer.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This enrichment is unnecessary for a competent core answer and remains subordinate to constitutional Articles, confidence, accountability, comparisons and PYQs.